MANAGALAS CONSERVATION AREA · STEWARD APP

# Field Guide

*For clan stewards & field officers — Version 3, October 2026*

How to use the app in the field: logging in, registering and monitoring, mapping, disturbance checks, and sending your data. The app works **offline** — record anything with no signal and it uploads later.

## 1 Logging in

The app uses your **fingerprint** to identify you — no username or password.

- Open the app from the **home-screen icon** (not a browser tab).
- Tap to log in and use your enrolled finger. If it fails, press firmly and hold; after three tries wait a moment and try again.
- If you are completely locked out, your coordinator must re-enrol you.

The app works **offline**. You can record everything with no signal; it saves to the phone and uploads later when you have internet.

**If a "Check your phone's date" warning appears** when you log in, your phone's date or time is wrong, and every record you collect would be stamped with the wrong date. Open **Settings → Date & Time** and turn on **Automatic / Network-provided** date & time, then tap **"I've fixed it — re-check."** Do this *before* collecting any data.

**If the app ever stops you from working** — a warning won't clear, something is broken — don't lose your time. Tap **Report a Problem** (on your **Profile**, or on the warning itself), write what happened, and **attach a screenshot** (take one with power + volume-down first). It saves even with no signal and reaches the coordinator with your next **Send Data**, so they can help and your work isn't lost.

## 2 How monitoring works — register first, then monitor

Most things you monitor go through two stages:

**1 Register it once.**

Walk to the water source, facility, instrument or tree, and record its type, location (GPS) and a reference photo. It is then **Pending Approval**.

**2 Monitor it monthly.**

After your coordinator approves it and assigns it to **your clan**, it appears as a task. You take the monthly reading.

**You only see your own clan's approved items.** If something belongs to another clan, it will not appear on your phone — that is deliberate, so two clans don't both monitor (and get paid for) the same thing. Each item can be read **once per clan per month**; after you record it, it shows **"Done this month."**

Every registration and every monthly reading needs a **photo**.

## 3 Water Quality

Open **Water Quality** from the dashboard.

- **Manage Water Sources** → register a new source (name, type, GPS, photo, description). Types are grouped:
  - **Natural:** River, Creek, Spring
  - **Engineered / manmade:** Reservoir & pipes, Ram pump, Solar pump, Well / borehole
- Your clan's **approved** sources appear as monitoring tasks. Tap a *Due* one, walk to it (the app unlocks within 30 m and asks for a fingerprint), then **Begin Reading**.

What you record depends on the type:

- **River:** water observations (colour, odour, flow, pollution) **plus a Secchi disc** depth reading.
- **Creek:** water observations **plus pond skaters** (surface insects — more usually means healthier water) **and shading** over the water.
- **Spring:** the core water observations.
- **Engineered (reservoir / pump / well):** a two-part check —
  - **Source condition:** is water present/flowing, is it clean & clear, any contamination signs.
  - **Delivery & infrastructure:** water at the tap/outlet, leaks, damage to pipes/tank/pump, and any repair needed.

Always finish with a **photo** of the source today.

## 4 Service Delivery Monitoring (schools & health)

Open **Service Delivery Monitoring**.

- **Manage Facilities** → register a school, health centre or aid post (name, type, GPS, photo, description) → Pending Approval.
- Your clan's approved facilities appear as tasks. Tap one to record a visit.

The visit form records whether the facility was **open / partial / closed**, **staff present**, and:

- **Schools:** total **students present** today.
- **Health centres / aid posts:** whether **essential medicines** are in stock.

Add notes and a **photo** of the facility today, then submit.

## 5 Weather Station / Met instruments

Open **Weather Station**.

- **Manage Met Stations** → register an instrument (name/location, type, GPS, photo). Types: **Rain gauge, Weather station, Water level meter**.
- Your clan's approved instruments appear as tasks. Tap one to record.

The reading form is centred on **equipment function**:

- Is the instrument **working / faulty / not working**? Any **damage** (none / minor / major)?
- **Rain gauge:** rainfall since last reading (mm), and whether you emptied the gauge afterwards.
- **Water level meter:** level at the marker (cm) and flow condition.
- **Weather station:** both of the above.

Add notes and a **photo**, then submit.

## 6 Phenology (monitored trees)

Open **Phenology Monitoring**.

**Establish a plant** (**Manage Plots** → establish → crop, GPS, photo → Pending Approval). When you establish it you must **mark the plant** so the same one is found every month:

- **Okari & Massoy (trees)** — with a project staff member present, **paint a band** at chest height on the trunk, and record the **DBH** (trunk diameter at 1.3 m) as the baseline. **Re-measure the DBH once a year.**
- **Vanilla, Cocoa, Coffee (cash crops)** — attach a **numbered metal tag** (= the Plant #) that does not harm the plant (a loose tie, not a nail).
- A **photo is required** at establishment for every plant.

**Monthly observation.** Once approved and assigned to your clan, plants appear under **Begin Monthly Observations**. For each plant:

- Tap **every phenophase present now** — you can select several at once — across **Leaves** (budburst, young, mature, colored/falling, bare), **Flowers** (buds, open) and **Fruit** (unripe, ripe, recent drop).
- Set **overall health** (good / fair / poor).
- **Trees:** enter a new **DBH** only on the annual re-measure (otherwise leave it blank).
- Add a **photo only if there is something to report**; add notes.

As with everything else, you only see **your clan's** approved trees, so two clans don't both claim the same tree.

## 7 Field Mapping & Observations

Open **Field Mapping** (also reached from the **Observations** and **Garden Mapping** tiles — they all open the same screen). Use it to record **anything you see**: a problem, an event, or something to map.

Pick what you're mapping:

- **Point** — one spot (plant problem, forest fire, landslide, fallen tree, non-compliance, social unrest, wildlife, hunting, cultural event…).
- **Line** — walk a route (a road/track).
- **Area / garden** — walk a **closed boundary**; the app gives the **area in hectares**. Choose the **Cash-crop garden** category and the crop picker appears (vanilla / coffee / cocoa / okari / massoy).

Two categories open a **structured form** so the data can be counted later: **Plant problem** (pick the crop, tick the problem(s) — pest, disease, dried out, poorly pruned, unharvested… — severity & how much is affected) and **Processing / sale prep** (for harvested crop being prepared for sale: crop, stage, quality problem(s) — dirty, mixed with stones, fungal, smoke contamination, under/over-dried, poorly packed… — severity & quantity).

Choose a **category**, add a **title**, a short **description**, and a **photo**, then **Save**. Your GPS is captured automatically. It saves offline and **uploads with your next Send Data** — no separate file is made. (In the recent-maps list each record has an **Export** button if you ever need a KML to share.)

## 8 Disturbance verification

Open **Disturbance Alerts**. A *disturbance* is a sudden change — a big **fire**, a **landslide**, or a **forest clearance over 2 ha** — flagged from satellite or reported, and routed to your clan to check on the ground.

- Walk to the site (it unlocks within ~50 m and asks for your fingerprint).
- Record what you found: **confirmed / not found / inconclusive / couldn't reach** — and the likely **cause** separately (natural / human / unclear). Report what you *see*; don't pre-judge.
- Take a **photo** and add the area. You are only ever sent disturbances already big enough to need checking — there's no "does it count" decision to make.

## 9 Handover & Distribution (field officers & staff)

*For **field officers** and **Project / MCF & Zone staff** who hand out items. The tile appears only for those roles.*

Open **Handover & Distribution** and record each handover **as it happens**:

- **Who received them** — name or group, recipient **type** (individual, clan group, women's / youth / church group, sports team, school, cooperative…), and clan. For a group, record **who physically received** them.
- **Purpose** — pick a category (conservation planting, agroforestry, livelihood, training support, relief…) and describe it.
- **Funded / donated by** — pick the **donor** (European Union, or another), and tick **"Donor recognised / acknowledged"** to confirm the donor was named and thanked to the recipients at the handover.
- **Items** — add each item with its **quantity and unit** (seeds, seedlings, tools, equipment, materials, PPE…). Tap **Add another item** for more.
- **Evidence** — a **handover photo**, a **receipt photo**, and a **short video (10–20 seconds)** of the items and the recipient receiving them.
- Tick **Recipient confirmed receipt**, then **verify your fingerprint** to submit.

GPS, the date and your identity are captured automatically as proof. It saves offline and uploads with **Send Data**. **Keep the video short** so it uploads on slow signal.

## 10 Sending your data

Open **Send Data**.

- **Send All New Records** uploads everything not yet sent (needs signal).
- If there's no direct signal, the app can open the Android **share sheet** so you can send the backup file to your coordinator via WhatsApp, or transfer it by USB. Your coordinator uploads it to Drive.
- **Storage Health** should show **"Data is protected."** If it says *NOT protected*, the app was opened from a browser tab — reinstall it from the home-screen icon (ask your coordinator).

> **Your data is safe while the phone has space and the app is installed to the home screen.** Send your records whenever you find signal so nothing is lost if the phone is damaged.

## 11 Getting around

- The phone's **back button** moves **back one screen** in the app (it no longer jumps out and loses your place). The ← at the top-left does the same.
- Pulling down to refresh no longer reloads the app, so you won't be bounced to the login screen by accident.
- The **Home / Map / Alerts / Profile** bar is along the bottom. Coordinators/project staff reach **MCF Summary** and **Coordinator Tools** from **Profile**.

## 12 Quick reference

| Task | Where |
|---|---|
| Log in | Fingerprint on the opening screen |
| Register a new thing | *Manage …* button inside its module |
| Do a monthly reading | Tap a *Due* item in the module's task list |
| See only my clan's work | Automatic — others' items are hidden |
| Send data | **Send Data → Send All New Records** |
| Check data is protected | **Send Data → Storage Health** |